Raspberry Pi VillageServer System

The Raspberry Pi is the small local server. It stores the library and creates the local Wi-Fi experience people use from their phones.

VillageServer Initiative printable field guide. Save this PDF on a phone, laptop, USB drive, or microSD card before travel.

Plain answer

Think of it as a small bookshelf with Wi-Fi. The phone connects to the bookshelf nearby instead of reaching out to the internet.

Field steps

1. Power the server - Connect the Raspberry Pi to the approved battery, wall power, or solar-supported power source.

2. Wait for the Wi-Fi name - Give the server time to start and broadcast the VillageServer network.

3. Join from a phone - Open Wi-Fi settings and connect to the VillageServer network. Mobile data is not required.

4. Open the library - Use the local address or captive portal shown with the kit.

5. Test one file - Open a Bible text, audio file, video, or PDF and confirm it loads on the phone.

6. Share what helps - Save useful files and pass them to another phone when needed.

Key points

What it is: A small computer configured as an offline resource library.

What it is not: It is not the public internet and does not require a data plan.

Best use: Groups of nearby phones that need access at the same location.

Board takeaway: The Raspberry Pi makes the library feel like joining Wi-Fi and opening a website.

Related website pages

Setup Guide

Field habit: do one small test first. Open one file, confirm it works offline, then teach the next person to repeat it.